Checkpoint Choke!

Naman Bhotika, a representative of The Reuters, reporting from the United Nations Security Council, reports on the agenda 'The Situation in the Middle East', focusing on "Freedom of Navigation and the Weaponization of Maritime Chokepoints"



(Source: The Reuters)

The United Nations Security Council Session commenced to discuss the situation in the Middle East and discuss solutions, however, the council spent no time in devolving into a chamber concerned solely with mentioning legal instruments and not spending any time working towards solutions.

It appeared as if delegates were more concerned over merely mentioning legalities or correcting others in a pretentious circus, even when the intent of the speaker was clear.
This is best summarized by an incident where the Delegate of the Syrian Arab Republic mis-quoted a legality pertaining to the UN Charter, and was met with corrections raised by 10 different delegates. This led to the committee having to address these points by spending 30 minutes on it. The mistake made by the delegate was that he mentioned 'Article 2 sub charter 4' instead of 'Article 2 (4)'.

The council transitioned into a moderated caucus addressing “Freedom of Navigation and the Weaponization of Maritime Chokepoints” in the afternoon. This shift brought no consensus among the delegates who failed to materialize any opinion or form any blocs which may lead to the resolution of the issue. The delegates from Washington used their time demanding unrestricted Maritime movement. Paris highlighted the economic damage caused by temporary restrictions in important maritime shipping routes. The Western Nations, led by the United States of America lobbied for an immediate restoration of pre-war maritime status for vital shipping routes. The Eastern Nations, while agreeing with the west on renewing regular operations in shipping routes, like the Strait of Hormuz, remained reserved with their approach and called for a multilateral solution.

The council concluded its proceedings for the day with no common opinion, no blocs formed among the delegates, and with the majority of the delegates not having laid out a concrete stance on not only the wider agenda, but also the sub-agendas.

This council appears to be adhering to the quote “ Two things are infinite: The universe and human stupidity” by Albert Einstein. This council needs to reach a consensus in order to deliver solutions and resolutions to the issues plaguing the world.